spring of 1813, the Sikh leader sent an expedition to Kashmir, which defeated the Governor who was holding Shuja and released him from his dungeon. Ranjit Singh then took the deposed Shah to Lahore. There he was separated from his harem, put under house arrest and told to fulfil his part in his wife's bargain by handing over the diamond. 'The ladies of our harem were accommodated in another mansion, to which we had, most vexatiously, no access,' wrote Shuja in his memoirs. 'Food and water rations were reduced or arbitrarily cut off, our servants sometimes allowed to go and sometimes forbidden from going about their business in the city.' He regarded this as a breach of the laws of hospitality. 'It was a display of oafish bad manners,' he wrote, dismissing Ranjit Singh, his one-eyed captor, as 'both vulgar and tyrannical, as well as ugly and low-natured'.[3]

Slowly, Ranjit increased the pressure. At the lowest ebb of his fortunes, Shuja was put in a cage, and, according to his own account, his eldest son, Prince Timur, was tortured in front of him until he agreed to part with his most valuable possession.[4] On 1 June 1813, Ranjit Singh arrived in person at Mubarak Haveli in the heart of the walled city and waited upon the Shah with a few attendants[e]. He was received by Shuja:

> with much dignity, and both being seated, a pause and solemn silence ensued, which continued for nearly an hour. Ranjit then, getting impatient, whispered to one of his attendants to remind the Shah of the object of his coming. No answer was returned, but the Shah with his eyes made a signal to a eunuch, who retired, and brought in a small roll, which he set down on the carpet at an equal distance between the chiefs. Ranjit Singh desired his eunuch to unfold the roll, and when the diamond was exhibited and recognized, the Sikh immediately retired with his prize in his hand.[5]

The Shah had honoured the agreement made by Wa'fa Begum, but at this point, having got what he wanted, Ranjit Singh reneged on his promise to release Shuja. Shah Shuja's jewels were not all that was of value; the deposed Shah too was potentially a lucrative asset. So the Maharajah kept him under house arrest, allowing him only the occasional carefully guarded outing for a picnic in the Shalimar Gardens. 'In flat contradiction to the treaty we had made,' wrote Shuja, 'it now transpired that, whenever we desired to take the air and visit gardens or shrines, spies would secretly follow us all around. We did not deign to take notice of them.'[6]

Shuja was at least allowed to summon the poets of Lahore to amuse him. One celebrated poet of the period, Rukn-ul Din Lahori 'Mukammal' ('Accomplished'), describes in his memoirs being summoned by Shuja to